

STUDENT SPOTLIGHT:
ALAINE “LAINEY” LAMBERT

This interview first appeared in the February 2021
National Coordinating Center Newsletter.

What is your name, where are you from, and what college are you attending?

My name is Alaine Lambert and I'm from Muskogee, OK. I go to school at Northeastern State University. I am a Junior.

What classes are you taking, and which is your favorite?

I like a couple: classes for my elementary school programs in physical education. And I have an art class called Drawing 1. I am very artistic. I like drawing names with bubble letters.

What do you like to do when you're not attending class?

I like spending time with my friends and mentors. I live on campus in a dorm, and I have a roommate. We like to color and listen to music. I work at Wesley Foundation. I help with organization. I go to Wednesday worship, we have lunch once a week, and evening meetings. Sometimes we have a bonfire and make hotdogs and s'mores.

What's good about college? (Like, what positive effects does it have on your life?)

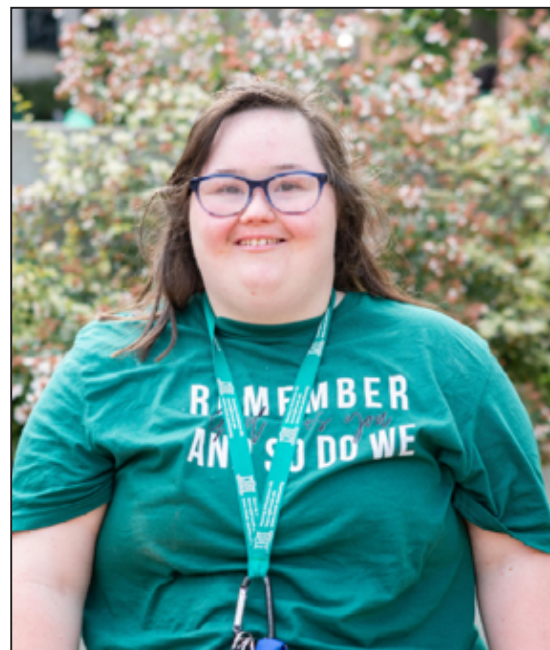
I like to meet friends. Sometimes I was nervous, I tried my best. I like going to school at Northeastern. The very best thing is going to class on time and having fun with friends. (Alaine is president of the Mentor Club). The club is for mentees and mentors, and I like to plan fitness & social events for the group. I helped to plan a game night – which was last night.

Can you share anything about how COVID has affected your college experience, maybe you learned something new, or overcame a challenge?

Because of COVID, we're wearing masks a lot. Classes are inside, and we are wearing masks. I had COVID last September. I'm OK now, I'm healthy.

What do you hope to do after college, when you graduate or get your certificate?

I want to teach young adults with disabilities. I like to coach, too. I would like to teach my kids and have fun and be friends with them.



Alaine on campus.



The very best thing is going to class on time and having fun with friends.

—Alaine

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If you or someone you know would like to be interviewed, contact sheila.johnson@umb.edu for more information.



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What advice do you have for students with disabilities who want to go to college?

I would tell them to go to school because they can work on their classes and their grades.

What about parents of students of students with disabilities, do you have advice for them?

I would tell them the truth about it... sometimes parents are concerned. That's OK. Lexi & Allison are my sisters. I tell them I can do things. I tell them I want to be independent. I set goals each week, like going to bed on time, or getting homework done for class.

What is something you'll do once the pandemic is over?

I'll go back to see my friends.



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Riverhawks Scholar Program, Northeastern State University, Muskogee, OK

The [Riverhawks Scholar Program](#) was the first comprehensive, inclusive program in Oklahoma. The program is a four-year certificate program. It provides the individualized supports in the areas of independent living, social skills, academics, and career development. Each semester, students take two traditional university courses and one program course. Students also participate in on campus and off campus internships each semester.

Watch a video about the program:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8lqGqPliY1k>



Thank you to Alaine for her time and willingness to share a bit about their college experience!

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